

The children stared, trying to make sense of what they were seeing. The creature had the neck of a snake, the horns of an ox, the belly of a clam, the scales of a fish, the ears of a cow, the head of a camel, the feet of a tiger, the eyes of a demon, and the claws of an eagle.

The children had never seen anything like it.

The creature danced around the children. Liu ran into the barn to look for Mui-Mui, but all of the animals had disappeared.

She caught up with her friends, desperate to ask for their help to find her cow.

"Look!" Chen called, pointing at the strange creature, "Mui-Mui is there! Look at its ears. She is part of this new animal, all the animals are. My snake has become its neck!"

Liu looked more closely at the magnificent creature. "You're right! Those are Mui-Mui's ears!" she shouted to Chen.

"It has my demon's eyes," their youngest friend said. "It will be able to spot danger anywhere and warn away bad spirits."

"It has my fish's scales," so it will be able to swim in the sea," another friend cried.

"It has the claws of my eagle, so it will be able to fly through the sky," Mei shouted across to Liu.

"What will we call this creature?" Liu asked.